

Lecture Points

CULTURE

1. Meaning of Culture

Culture is the complete pattern of life that people follow in a society. It includes not only visible things like clothes, food, houses, and tools, but also invisible ideas such as beliefs, values, attitudes, ideas, knowledge, customs, and traditions. Culture explains how people live, how they think, and how they behave in daily life.

Culture provides people with guidelines for living. It tells individuals what behavior is acceptable and what behavior is not acceptable. It also helps people understand their roles and responsibilities in society.

Culture helps people:

- Decide what is right and wrong
- Understand social expectations
- Perform social roles properly
- Maintain social order
- Feel a sense of identity and belonging

Culture is learned gradually from birth and continues throughout life through family, school, religion, friends, and media.

More Examples:

- Greeting elders with respect is culture
- Celebrating religious festivals in a specific way is culture
- Wearing traditional dress on special occasions is culture

2. Nature of Culture

Culture shapes human life in a deep and continuous way. It influences daily routines, social relations, thinking patterns, and problem-solving methods. Culture develops slowly over time and becomes strong through repeated practice.

Culture also provides social control, meaning it guides people to behave in acceptable ways without force.

Culture is Social

Culture exists only where people live together. Interaction, cooperation, and communication are necessary for culture to survive and grow.

Culture develops through:

- Family life

- Community living
- Social institutions

Example:

Customs of marriage differ because societies are different.

Culture is Learned, Not Inborn

Culture is acquired through socialization. Children learn culture by observing and copying others.

Learning culture helps individuals:

- Adjust to society
- Understand expectations
- Build social skills

Example:

Learning how to speak politely is cultural learning.

Culture is Shared

Culture is shared by members of a society, creating common behavior and understanding. Shared culture reduces confusion and conflict.

Example:

Common prayer times create social harmony.

3. Characteristics of Culture

1. Culture is Learned

Culture is not instinctive; it is learned through continuous interaction with family, society, and institutions. Learning culture helps individuals understand how to behave in different social situations.

People learn culture through:

- Observation of elders and peers
- Formal education in schools
- Religious teachings
- Media such as television and social media

Cultural learning continues throughout life as society changes.

Example:

People learn workplace ethics when they start jobs.

2. Culture is Shared

Culture is shared by members of a society, which creates unity and cooperation. Shared culture allows people to communicate effectively and understand social expectations.

Shared culture helps in:

- Predicting behavior
- Reducing misunderstandings
- Maintaining harmony

Example:

Shared customs during festivals unite people.

3. Culture is Transmitted from Generation to Generation

Culture is passed from elders to younger generations through teaching, imitation, and social practices. This transmission keeps traditions alive.

Means of transmission include:

- Family traditions
- Religious practices
- Education system

Example:

Traditional values are taught through family stories.

4. Culture is Cumulative

Culture accumulates knowledge, experiences, and practices over time. New ideas are added to existing traditions, improving social life.

This process allows societies to progress.

Example:

Modern education systems build upon traditional knowledge.

5. Culture is Dynamic

Culture changes as society responds to new challenges and opportunities. These changes are influenced by technology, education, and interaction with other cultures.

Cultural change helps society adapt to modern needs.

Example:

Digital communication has changed social interaction.

6. Culture is Integrated

All elements of culture are interconnected. A change in one aspect affects other aspects of culture.

This integration ensures balance and consistency.

Example:

Educational change influences family and work life.

7. Culture is Adaptive

Culture helps people adjust to environmental and social conditions. Adaptive culture supports survival and development.

Example:

Food habits change according to climate and resources.

4. Components of Culture

A. Material Culture

Material culture includes all physical and tangible objects created and used by humans. These objects make life comfortable and efficient and reflect the level of scientific and technological development of a society.

Material culture plays an important role in meeting basic human needs such as food, shelter, and transportation. It also shows social differences such as rich and poor, urban and rural life.

Material culture changes rapidly due to inventions and technological progress.

Examples:

- Houses, buildings, and roads
- Machines, tools, and factories
- Mobile phones, computers, and internet devices
- Clothing and household items

Material culture helps people save time, increase productivity, and improve quality of life.

B. Non-Material Culture

Non-material culture consists of ideas, beliefs, values, and rules that guide human behavior. It provides meaning to life and controls actions through social approval or disapproval.

Non-material culture is more stable than material culture but changes slowly over time.

It includes:

- Values that define good and bad
- Beliefs that shape thinking
- Norms that regulate behavior
- Customs and traditions
- Religion and moral codes

Non-material culture creates discipline, morality, and social harmony.

5. Norms in Culture

Norms are rules and standards of behavior that guide how people should act in society. Norms help maintain order, discipline, and stability. They tell people what is considered right, wrong, acceptable, or unacceptable.

Norms are different in every culture and may change over time.

1. Folkways

Folkways are simple and routine rules of everyday life. They guide daily behavior and social manners. Breaking folkways does not cause serious punishment but may lead to social disapproval.

Examples:

- Greeting people politely
- Dressing properly in public
- Table manners

Breaking folkways may result in:

- Criticism
- Embarrassment
- Disapproval

2. Mores

Mores are strong moral rules that are essential for the well-being of society. They are closely related to morality and ethics. Violating mores causes strong social reaction and legal consequences.

Examples:

- Theft
- Murder
- Cheating
- Dishonesty

Breaking mores may lead to:

- Social rejection
- Legal punishment
- Loss of respect

3. Laws

Laws are formal and written rules made by the state to control behavior and maintain social order. Laws are enforced by government institutions such as police and courts. Every citizen is expected to follow laws.

Laws are based on cultural values and social norms.

Examples:

- Traffic laws
- Criminal laws
- Education laws

Breaking laws results in:

- Fines
- Imprisonment
- Legal punishment

6. Symbols in Culture

Symbols give meaning to life.

More Examples:

- Wedding ring = marriage
- Green color = Islam

7. Language and Culture

Language is the foundation of culture. It allows people to communicate ideas, share experiences, and pass culture from one generation to another.

Language shapes thinking and influences how people understand the world. Different languages express ideas in different ways.

Language helps to:

- Preserve history and traditions
- Express emotions and feelings
- Maintain social relationships

Without language, culture cannot survive or develop.

8. Values in Culture

Values are shared ideas about what is considered good, bad, right, or wrong in a society. They guide human behavior and decision-making.

Values influence:

- Personal behavior
- Social relationships
- Laws and norms

Values help maintain discipline and moral standards.

Examples:

- Respect for elders
- Honesty and truthfulness
- Justice and fairness

9. Beliefs in Culture

Beliefs are ideas that people accept as true without proof. They give meaning to life and influence actions and attitudes.

Beliefs may be religious, social, or personal.

Beliefs affect:

- Daily behavior
- Customs and traditions
- Moral judgments

Strong beliefs help people face difficulties and uncertainties.

10. Cultural Diversity

Cultural diversity means the existence of different cultures within a society or across the world. Each culture has its own traditions, language, values, and lifestyle.

Cultural diversity promotes tolerance, understanding, and mutual respect among people.

Living in a diverse society helps people learn new ideas and develop open-mindedness.

11. Subculture

A subculture is a group within a larger society that has its own unique patterns of behavior, values, and norms while still sharing the main culture.

Subcultures develop due to:

- Age differences
- Occupation
- Education
- Interests

Subcultures add variety and richness to society.

12. Importance of Culture

Culture plays a central role in human life. It shapes personal behavior and social institutions.

Culture:

- Gives identity and recognition
- Maintains social order
- Teaches moral values
- Creates cooperation and unity
- Preserves traditions
- Guides social behavior

Without culture:

- Society would be disorganized
- People would not understand right and wrong
- There would be no cooperation

Culture also provides emotional security and social belonging.

13. Culture and Society

Culture and society are closely connected and cannot exist without each other. Society is a group of people who live together, while culture is the way of life they follow. Society provides the structure, and culture provides the rules and meanings for living together.

Society is made up of people, relationships, and institutions such as family, education, religion, and government. Culture gives these institutions guidelines about how they should function. Without culture, society would have no direction, and people would not know how to behave with one another.

Culture controls society by setting norms, values, customs, and laws. These cultural elements guide people's behavior and help maintain order and discipline. For example, respect for elders is a cultural value that shapes family relations in society.

At the same time, society also creates and shapes culture. As society changes due to education, technology, or social needs, culture also changes. New ways of communication, dressing, and working develop as society evolves.

Culture helps society by:

- Creating unity and cooperation
- Providing identity to individuals
- Maintaining social order
- Teaching moral values
- Regulating behavior through norms and laws

Society helps culture by:

- Providing people to practice culture
- Passing culture from one generation to another
- Protecting cultural traditions
- Allowing cultural development and change

Culture and society influence each other continuously. A change in society brings change in culture, and a change in culture affects society. For example, improvement in education changes cultural thinking, which then changes social behavior.

14. Culture and Personality

Culture plays a major role in shaping personality. It influences how individuals think, behave, communicate, and express emotions.

Culture determines:

- Attitudes toward elders
- Gender roles
- Work habits
- Social manners

Through culture, individuals learn self-control, confidence, and social responsibility.

15. Culture and Social Change

Culture plays a key role in social change.

Example:

Education changes thinking patterns.

PAKISTANI SOCIETY AND CULTURE

1. Introduction to Pakistani Society and Culture

Pakistani society and culture are shaped by history, religion, geography, and social traditions. Pakistan is a country where many ethnic groups, languages, and regional cultures live together. Although people may differ in lifestyle and customs, they share common social values.

Pakistani culture is:

- Religious in nature
- Family-centered
- Community-oriented
- Respect-based

Pakistani society believes more in collective life rather than individual life. People care about family reputation, social respect, and religious duties. Community opinions are important, and decisions often involve consultation with elders and family members.

Example:

Even in modern cities, people consult elders before making major decisions like marriage, business, or educational paths. Social gatherings and communal events reinforce the feeling of belonging and shared responsibility.

2. Historical Background of Pakistani Society

Pakistani society is the result of thousands of years of civilization and cultural mixing. Each historical period contributed new values, practices, and social structures that shape Pakistani life today.

A. Indus Valley Civilization

This was one of the earliest urban civilizations in the world.

Social Contributions:

- Planned cities show discipline, organization, and civic responsibility
- Drainage systems show concern for hygiene and public health
- Trade and marketplaces show economic cooperation and skill

Cultural Impact:

It laid the foundation of organized social life, urban planning, and communal living.

Example:

Uniform brick houses and street layouts show that citizens followed shared rules and social equality.

B. Aryan and Pre-Islamic Influence

Aryans introduced:

- Agriculture techniques and animal domestication
- Early languages that influenced local dialects
- Social classification and structured family roles

This period influenced early social organization, rituals, and community cooperation.

C. Islamic Period

Islam brought a complete social and moral system.

Islamic Values Introduced:

- Equality of all humans before God
- Justice and fairness
- Charity and helping the needy
- Brotherhood and community cohesion

Islam reduced social discrimination and strengthened ethical living.

Example:

Rich and poor stand together in congregational prayers and share religious duties equally.

D. Mughal Period

Mughals strengthened:

- Art, literature, and architecture
- Music, poetry, and cultural expression
- Urban planning and gardens

They blended Islamic and local cultures, creating a rich cultural legacy.

Example:

Gardens and mosques became not just places of worship but also social gathering points for communities.

E. British Period

British rule changed society deeply.

Changes Introduced:

- English education and bureaucratic systems
- Railways and infrastructure development
- Courts and formal legal systems

These modernized society but also created class differences and new social hierarchies.

Example:

English-speaking people often gained higher social status, influencing jobs and governance.

F. Creation of Pakistan (1947)

Pakistan was created to allow Muslims to live according to Islamic and cultural values.

Social Challenges:

- Migration and refugee crises
- Poverty and scarcity
- National integration among diverse ethnic groups

Example:

Different ethnic groups like Punjabis, Sindhis, Pashtuns, and Balochis had to unite under a common national identity.

3. Islamic Influence on Pakistani Society

Islam is the **core pillar** of Pakistani society, influencing social behavior, law, education, and family systems.

A. Islamic Beliefs

Islam teaches belief in one God, accountability for actions, and moral responsibility. These beliefs shape personal ethics, honesty, and fairness.

Example:

People avoid dishonesty, bribery, and exploitation due to fear of accountability to God.

B. Islamic Practices

Islam guides daily life through prayer, fasting, charity, and social ethics.

Example:

During Ramadan, daily routines, eating habits, and social interactions change to promote empathy, discipline, and communal harmony.

C. Islamic Social Values

Islam promotes respect, modesty, justice, and kindness.

Example:

Helping neighbors during illness, giving charity, and respecting women are part of social life.

4. Family System in Pakistan

Family is the **backbone** of Pakistani society, shaping social norms, economic support, and moral upbringing.

A. Importance of Family

Family provides emotional security, moral education, and financial support. Children learn ethics, language, and social behavior from family first.

Example:

Parents guide children on manners, religion, and how to treat elders with respect.

B. Joint Family System

Many generations live together, sharing responsibilities and maintaining strong family bonds.

Benefits:

- Care for children and elders
- Shared economic responsibilities
- Emotional support and guidance

Problems:

- Conflicts among members
- Lack of independence for younger generation

Example:

Grandparents play a key role in teaching traditions, values, and family history.

C. Nuclear Family System

Nuclear families are common in cities due to modernization, jobs, and housing constraints.

Reasons:

- Employment patterns
- Urban living space limitations
- Educational needs of children

Example:

Small families in apartments often balance work and child-rearing without extended family.

5. Social Values of Pakistani Society

Social values guide behavior and maintain moral and ethical standards.

A. Respect for Elders

Elders are honored for experience and wisdom. Their advice guides family and community decisions.

Example:

Children rise when elders enter a room and seek their counsel before making important decisions.

B. Hospitality

Guests are treated generously, as it is considered a moral and religious duty.

Example:

Serving the best food and ensuring comfort for guests, even beyond one's means.

C. Family Honor (Izzat)

Family reputation is central. Decisions and actions are often taken to protect family name.

Example:

Conflicts are resolved privately to avoid public embarrassment or shame.

D. Religious Commitment

Religion is integrated into daily life, guiding moral choices, ethical work, and personal conduct.

Example:

Avoiding interest-based loans, unethical jobs, and haram income.

6. Language and Linguistic Diversity

Pakistan has rich linguistic diversity with **Urdu, Punjabi, Sindhi, Pashto, Balochi, Saraiki**, and many local dialects.

A. Urdu

National language, symbol of unity, used in media, education, and government communication.

Example:

Urdu helps connect people from different regions during national events.

B. Regional Languages

Regional languages preserve history, express cultural identity, and maintain local literature and folklore.

Example:

Punjabi folk songs reflect rural life and traditional practices.

7. Dress and Food Culture

A. Dress Culture

Clothing reflects religion, climate, and cultural heritage. Shalwar kameez is common across Pakistan.

Example:

Loose, cotton clothing suits hot climates and allows modesty in line with cultural values.

B. Food Culture

Food promotes social bonding. Shared meals reflect hospitality, family unity, and community ties.

Example:

Traditional dishes served during festivals, weddings, and communal gatherings.

8. Customs and Traditions

A. Birth Customs

Azan, naming ceremonies, and celebration of newborns with family and community involvement.

Example:

Relatives distribute sweets and gifts to celebrate a child's birth.

B. Marriage Customs

Marriage is a social, cultural, and religious institution involving family negotiations, ceremonies, and celebrations.

Example:

Nikah and Walima ceremonies involve prayers, witnesses, and communal feasts.

C. Death Rituals

Funerals involve prayers, community participation, and mourning according to religious guidelines.

Example:

Neighbors help family in burial and offer condolences to show respect.

9. Festivals and Celebrations

Religious Festivals

Eid-ul-Fitr, Eid-ul-Adha, and Ramadan promote spiritual reflection, charity, and family unity.

Example:

Sharing food with the poor, gathering for prayers, and strengthening community bonds.

National Festivals

Celebrate patriotism, historical achievements, and national pride.

Example:

Flag hoisting, parades, and speeches on 14 August to celebrate independence.

10. Arts and Cultural Expression

A. Architecture

Mosques, forts, and historical monuments reflect Islamic and regional heritage.

Example:

Badshahi Mosque shows Mughal artistry and community gathering spaces.

B. Music

Qawwali, folk songs, and classical music express cultural identity and spiritual values.

Example:

Sufi music promotes peace, devotion, and cultural continuity.

C. Handicrafts

Local crafts reflect creativity, heritage, and economic activity.

Example:

Truck art, embroidery, and pottery showcase regional skills and cultural pride.

11. Education and Socialization

Education

Education shapes knowledge, awareness, thinking, and citizenship.

Example:

Schools promote tolerance, discipline, and understanding of rights and duties.

Socialization

Socialization teaches norms, values, and expected behaviors through family, school, and community.

Example:

Children learn respect, punctuality, and teamwork in school and community settings.

12. Media and Society

Media plays a critical role in shaping public opinion, cultural trends, and awareness.

Positive Role

Education, news, cultural programs, and awareness campaigns strengthen knowledge and social responsibility.

Negative Role

Exposure to foreign media can lead to imitation, cultural erosion, and unrealistic social expectations.

Example:

Western fashion trends influencing urban youth attire.

13. Political System and Society

Politics impacts laws, governance, social justice, and resource distribution.

Example:

Government welfare programs improve education, healthcare, and social equality.

14. Social Change and Modernization

Modernization affects lifestyle, values, and social institutions.

Positive Effects

Education, especially for women, technology use, and economic development empower individuals.

Negative Effects

Family structure may weaken, traditional values may be challenged, and urbanization may increase stress.

Example:

Families may have less interaction due to mobile phones and online work.

15. Globalization and Pakistani Society

Globalization brings international exposure, economic opportunities, and technological progress.

Positive Effects

Job opportunities, access to information, modern healthcare, and global trade.

Negative Effects

Cultural erosion, weakening of local traditions, and imitation of foreign lifestyles.

16. Social Problems in Pakistani Society

Key issues include poverty, illiteracy, unemployment, corruption, and gender inequality.

Example:

Girls in rural areas often have limited access to quality education, reducing future opportunities.

17. Future of Pakistani Society and Culture

The future depends on education, youth involvement, technological adaptation, and cultural preservation.

Example:

Social media campaigns to promote local heritage, language, and crafts help sustain cultural identity.